

Task & Content Analysis

Original vs. Revised — Audited Against the Digital-Literacy-Novice Learner Profile

The Needs & Audience Analysis defines who this learner is: someone who may be operating a touchscreen for the first time, has no open internet access, and loses confidence quickly when a task fails without a clear reason. This document audits "Discovering Your Narrative Voice" against that profile — not by asking whether each screen teaches good writing craft, but by asking what the learner is actually required to do to get through it, what prior knowledge that requires, and where a first-time tablet user with no internet access would get stuck.

The five screens below are the same ones flagged in the Content Review Case Study. That document asks whether the content is appropriate and trauma-informed. This one asks a narrower, earlier question: can this specific learner physically and cognitively complete the task as designed — separate from whether the content itself is good.

1. Task Inventory — Original Module

What each flagged screen actually requires the learner to do, and what it assumes they already know how to do.

Screen	Task Required of Learner	Prerequisite Knowledge Assumed	Failure Point for This Audience
2	Watch a locked video with no visible controls; wait for it to end before the app allows any further input.	That a black screen with no button means "wait," not "broken." That there is no way to speed up, skip, or exit.	A first-time tablet user has no way to distinguish a frozen app from a locked video. The two look identical: an unresponsive screen.
5	Recognize three lines of underlined text as clickable links, then tap one to leave the app.	That underlined text = a hyperlink (a learned convention, not universal), and that tapping it will open a browser.	On a closed platform the tap does nothing or errors. The learner has no way to know whether they did something wrong or the app is broken.
7	Same as screen 2 — second locked video, no controls.	Same as screen 2.	Same as screen 2, compounded: a second unexplained lock reinforces the learner's uncertainty about whether the app is functioning correctly.
8	Tap an external link to a short-story website, choose a story there, return to the app, then complete a rewrite task based on it.	Multi-app navigation: opening a browser, searching within an unfamiliar site, then finding your way back to the original app without losing your place.	This is the highest-risk task in the module. It requires successful navigation of a system (open web) the learner may have never used, with no path back if any step fails.
11	Read seven prompts and write freeform answers in a class journal for each.	Comfort with open-ended writing tasks and a reading level sufficient to parse each prompt (including the phrase "broken home," which assumes a shared, uncomplicated understanding of the term).	No task-completion barrier here — the barrier is content appropriateness, which is why this screen is flagged in the case study, not this document. Included for completeness.

2. Content Dependency Analysis

Which parts of the module depend on something outside the module itself to function:

- Screens 5 and 8 both depend on live internet access and a functioning external website. Neither is optional for the task — screen 5's entire content is the links, and screen 8's activity cannot be completed without reaching a source story.
- Screens 2 and 7 depend on the video finishing without technical failure (buffering, corrupted file) since there is no manual override if it doesn't.
- Screen 11 depends on nothing external — it's a self-contained writing task. Its barrier is entirely about language choice, not system dependency, which is a different category of fix.

3. Original vs. Revised — Task Demand Comparison

Screen	Original Task Demand	Revised Task Demand
2 / 7	Learner must wait through the full video with no visible way to progress; a stalled or buffering video is indistinguishable from a broken app.	Learner can skip immediately if they choose to, or watch and continue on their own signal. A visible button removes the ambiguity between "loading" and "locked."
5	Learner must recognize link conventions, leave the closed platform successfully, and return — a multi-step task with no in-app path back if it fails.	No external navigation required. Content is read directly on-screen, same interaction pattern as every other text screen in the module.
8	Learner must complete the same external-navigation task as screen 5, this time as a hard dependency for finishing the activity.	Source material is embedded on-screen. The task becomes read-then-write, using only interaction patterns the learner has already used elsewhere in the module.

4. Findings

- Every task-completion barrier identified here traces back to one root cause: the module assumes an interaction vocabulary (hyperlinks, multi-app navigation, ambiguous loading states) that a general digital-native audience has but this audience cannot be assumed to have.
- The two video screens and the two link-dependent screens are the highest-risk points in the module for task failure — not because the content is wrong, but because completing the task at all depends on system knowledge the learner may not have.
- Fixing these is a different job than fixing screen 11. Screen 11 needed a content judgment call. Screens 2, 5, 7, and 8 needed the task itself redesigned so it no longer depends on knowledge outside the platform.
- None of the fixes reduce what the learner is asked to think about or create — they reduce what the learner has to already know how to operate before they can get to the thinking part.